

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 94-263

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR

CITY OF RIPON
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
SAN JOAQUIN COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. City of Ripon (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge, dated 26 January 1994. Supplemental information was received on 11 February and on 16 June 1994.
2. The City of Ripon wastewater treatment facility is in Sections 25 and 36, T2S, R7E, and Sections 30 and 31, T2S, R8E of MDB&M, as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference.
3. Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 85-120, adopted by the Board on 31 May 1985, prescribes requirements for a discharge of the City of Ripon's municipal and industrial wastewaters.
4. Order No. 85-120 is neither adequate nor consistent with current plans and policies of the Board.
5. The Discharger discharges 800,000 gallons per day of municipal wastewater to the treatment and disposal ponds owned by the City of Ripon, as shown in Attachment B, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference.
6. The domestic wastewater is sent through grinders to provide some solids size reduction prior to being distributed to the treatment and then to the percolation ponds for disposal.
7. The Discharger currently receives 170,000 gallons per day of industrial wastewater from two industries; Nulaid and Nestles Corporations.
8. The Nestle plant operations in Ripon, closed in the spring of 1994, which reduced their industrial flows to the wastewater treatment facility by 110,000 gallons per day (gpd).
9. The Nestles' site is currently involved in a ground water cleanup program under the Board's Spills, Leaks, Investigations, and Cleanup Unit. The anticipated ground water remediation method to be implemented is ground water extraction, treatment to remove volatile organics, discharge to Ripon's combined industrial/stormwater sewer system with ultimate disposal to the Discharger's industrial wastewater disposal area at the wastewater treatment facility. The 220,000 gpd flows generated by Nestle's ground water remediation efforts will be the only industrial type flows generated from the Nestle plant.
10. During the summer months and periods of dry weather, the industrial wastewater receives no treatment and is applied directly to land as sheet flow irrigation which percolates into the ground at the sixteen (16) acre disposal area, as shown in Attachment B.
11. During the winter months and periods of wet weather, the industrial wastewater is discharged to the domestic wastewater percolation ponds.

12. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Second Edition, for the Sacramento-San Joaquin Basin (hereafter Basin Plan), which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
13. The beneficial uses of the Stanislaus River are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation; aesthetic enjoyment; navigation; ground water recharge; freshwater replenishment; hydropower generation; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife, and other aquatic resources.
14. The beneficial uses of underlying ground water are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
15. The Basin Plan encourages land disposal including reclamation. The Discharger has performed a preliminary evaluation into the feasibility for increased use of effluent on irrigated land. These Waste Discharge Requirements require the Discharger to investigate the feasibility of implementing additional land disposal including reclamation/reuse of Ripon's wastewater.
16. The action to update waste discharge requirements for this facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15301.
17. This discharge is exempt from the requirements of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq. (hereafter Chapter 15). The exemption, pursuant to Section 2511(b), is based on the following:
 - a. Waste Discharge Requirements are being issued, and
 - b. The discharge is in compliance with the Basin Plan, and
 - c. The wastewater does not need to be managed according to Chapter 30 of Division 4 of Title 22 California Code of Regulations.
18. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
19. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 85-120 is rescinded and the City of Ripon, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous' or 'designated', as defined in Sections 2521(a) and 2522(a) of Chapter 15, is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The monthly average discharge flow to the disposal/percolation ponds shall not exceed 1.40 million gallons/day (mgd). After submittal of a technical report, construction or obtaining of additional disposal facilities, and approval of the Executive Officer; the monthly average discharge flow can be increased to 2.34 mgd.
2. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and disposal areas.
3. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. B.2, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in treatment and disposal ponds shall be greater than 1.0 mg/l for at least 16 hours for any 24 hour period.
4. The treatment and disposal facilities shall be designed, constructed, operated, and maintained to prevent inundation, washout due to a storm event with a **100 year** return frequency.
5. Influent to the wastewater disposal ponds shall not cause the ponds to have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
6. There shall be no standing water in the six (6) acre industrial wastewater disposal area 24 hours after completion of wastewater application.
7. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitoes. In particular,
 - a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
8. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, and other acceptable alternatives.
9. Percolation ponds shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration during the rainy season. Design seasonal precipitation shall be based on total annual precipitation using a return period of **100 years**, distributed monthly in accordance with historical rainfall patterns. Freeboard shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).
10. On or about **1 October** of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification B.9.

C. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with Chapter 15, Division 3, Title 23, of the California Code of Regulations and approved by the Executive Officer.

2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice from a previously approved practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage sludge shall comply with existing Federal and State laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503.

If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards are given the authority to implement regulations contained in 40 CFR 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The Discharger must comply with the standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR 503 whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

5. The Discharger shall submit a sludge disposal plan **60 days** prior to any sludge removal from the WWF.

D. Ground Water Limitations:

The discharge shall not cause underlying ground water to:

1. Contain waste constituents in concentrations statistically greater than background water quality. (For purposes of comparison, background water quality shall be determined when background monitoring provides sufficient data. Quality determined in this manner establishes "water quality protection standards.")
2. Contain chemicals, heavy metals, or trace elements in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses or exceed maximum contaminant levels specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
3. Exceed a most probable number of total coliform organisms of 2.2/100 ml over any seven-day period.
4. Exceed concentrations of radionuclides specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
5. Contain taste or odor-producing substances in concentrations that cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.
6. Contain concentrations of chemical constituents in amounts that adversely affect agricultural use.

E. Provisions:

1. The Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 94-263 which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by

reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."

3. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.
4. At least **90 days** prior to termination or expiration of any lease, contract, or agreement involving disposal or reclamation areas or off-site reuse of effluent, used to justify the capacity authorized herein and assure compliance with this Order, the Discharger shall notify the Board in writing of the situation and of what measures have been taken or are being taken to assure full compliance with this Order.
5. The Discharger shall use the best practicable cost-effective control technique currently available to limit mineralization to no more than a reasonable increment.
6. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
7. The Discharger shall comply with the following time schedule to assure the treatment and disposal ponds comply with Discharge Specification B.9 of this order; under existing flow conditions (1.4 mgd) and future flow conditions (2.34 mgd):
 - a. Submit a liquid mass balance for influent flows: **15 January 1995**
 - b. **If needed**, submit plans for improvements: **15 March 1995**
 - c. **If needed**, complete improvements for existing flows: **1 October 1995**
8. The Discharger shall comply with the following time schedule to assure compliance with Ground Water Limitation D.1 through D.6 of this Order:
 - a. Submit a Ground Water Monitoring Plan: **15 February 1995**
 - b. Install ground water monitoring wells: **1 June 1995**
 - c. Submit results of first quarterly ground water analyses: **1 September 1995**
 - d. Submit a ground water assessment report with proposed Water Quality Protection Standards : **1 June 1996**

The Discharger shall submit to the Board on or before each compliance report date, a report detailing compliance or noncompliance with the specific schedule date and task. If noncompliance is being reported, the reasons for such noncompliance shall be stated, plus an estimate of the date when the Discharger will be in compliance. The Discharger shall notify the Board by letter when it returns to compliance with the time schedule.

9. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.
10. If reclaimed water is used for construction purposes, it shall comply with the most current edition of *Guidelines for Use of Reclaimed Water for Construction Purposes*. Other uses of reclaimed

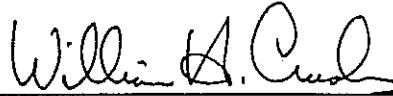
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water not specifically authorized herein shall be subject to the approval of the Executive Officer and shall comply with 22 CCR, Division 4:

11. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on 16 September 1994.



WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer